



Page 1 of 7 · Two Dark Paths

The woodland picnic ends beneath a purple sky. Ted-E-Bear has 8 little lanterns. One path leads to Honey-Beats’s cottage and the other leads to his own. “Nobody should walk home in the dark,” Ted says.



Page 2 of 7 · The Windy Bend

At the bend, the wind blows out 2 of Honey-Beats’s 4 lanterns. Ted hears a worried little hum beyond the trees and turns back.



Page 3 of 7 · A Brave Small Glow

Two lanterns are not much, but Honey-Beats holds them high. “Small lights still count,” she says. Ted places one lantern on each side of the narrow bridge.



Page 4 of 7 · Fireflies Join In

Three fireflies settle near each lantern. Their gold-green light makes the bridge sparkle, and Honey-Beats’s shoulders finally relax.



Page 5 of 7 · The Last Hill

The cottage window appears at the top of the hill. Ted has 6 lanterns left in his wagon and wants both friends to carry the same number.



Page 6 of 7 · Light in Every Window

Honey-Beats places 3 lanterns outside. Ted places 3 inside. The cottage glows like a tiny sunrise, and the dark no longer feels so large.



Page 7 of 7 · A Promise Kept

Before Ted leaves, Honey-Beats gives him half of 4 honey biscuits for his walk. “You came back for me,” she says. Ted smiles. “That is what friends do.” Both paths shine all the way home.

Questions for Ted-E-Bear and the Lantern That Needed a Half

Read the story together first. Use one question at each page, then the question at the end. Answers are below the dotted line: fold them under or cover them while reading.

Page 1 · Two Dark Paths

If Ted shares 8 lanterns equally between 2 paths, how many lanterns light each path?

Choices: 2 · 3 · 4 · 6

Page 2 · The Windy Bend

Honey-Beats had 4 glowing lanterns and 2 went out. How many are still glowing?

Choices: 1 · 2 · 3 · 4

Page 3 · A Brave Small Glow

Ted doubles 1 lantern so both sides match. How many lanterns are there altogether?

Choices: 1 · 2 · 3 · 4

Page 4 · Fireflies Join In

There are 2 lanterns with 3 fireflies beside each one. How many fireflies are helping?

Choices: 4 · 5 · 6 · 8

Page 5 · The Last Hill

What is half of 6 lanterns?

Choices: 2 · 3 · 4 · 6

Page 6 · Light in Every Window

What is double 3?

Choices: 4 · 5 · 6 · 8

Page 7 · A Promise Kept

How many biscuits is half of 4?

Choices: 1 · 2 · 3 · 4

Answers (fold under before reading)

Page 1: 4. A half means two equal groups. Share one lantern to each path until all 8 are used: 4 on each path.

Page 2: 2. Take away the 2 lanterns that went out: 4 - 2 = 2.

Page 3: 2. Double 1 means 1 + 1. That makes 2.

Page 4: 6. There are two equal groups of 3. Count 3 + 3 = 6 fireflies.

Page 5: 3. Split 6 into two equal groups: 3 and 3. Half of 6 is 3.

Page 6: 6. Double 3 is two groups of 3: 3 + 3 = 6.

Page 7: 2. Four shared into two equal parts is 2 and 2. Half of 4 is 2.

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